



AI GENERATED IMAGE BY **HARDIK CHHABRA**

bodies, institutions, corporations, and organisations are motivated to make their datasets public voluntarily. A call to action for “Data Daan” is the need of the hour to build a national movement on donating data for a digital India, where AI models accurately reflect the Indian context. Such a national call to action could also empower Indian developers and researchers to address the requirements of uniquely Indian use cases through indigenous models.

Secondly, it would be to India’s advantage to tap its vast human resource pool to provide value-added data services focussed on annotating and enriching these public datasets to aid and accelerate in model training and development. Data enrichment services that require both data skills and specialised knowledge of specific domains could drive the next wave of AI-era jobs but could also position India as a global service provider for these services requiring deep domain knowledge.

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Lastly, vast portions of India’s public sector that have lagged in digitalisation have the unique opportunity to leapfrog into the AI era without the baggage of legacy IT systems and unfriendly interfaces, which have largely contributed to the digital divide. From education to local governance, we have the opportunity with AI to bridge the digital gap in the last mile of public service delivery by overcoming language barriers and capacity limitations of our public bodies through a new class of AI-enabled digital public goods.

India, with its demographic dividend and technological prowess, can strike a different regulatory path that not only embraces but also safeguards societal interests. It has the opportunity to show the world the way to keep developmental priorities front and centre in the evolution of AI systems. **BT**

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